



betterservices **better**outcomes

FORGING
OUR FUTURE
December 9–10 2005

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Novotel Northbeach Wollongong December 9–10 2005

BACKGROUND

NSW Consumer Advisory Group – Mental Health Inc. (NSW CAG) in partnership with the Illawarra Institute for Mental Health (iiMH) and the University of Wollongong will host a consumer and carer led gathering of interested stakeholders. The three-day gathering will highlight many of the various aspects of mental health consumer and carer participation. The forum will be celebrating how far we have come since 1992. It will also highlight some of the changes and future directions for mental health services in NSW.

The venue for the gathering will be the Novotel Northbeach, at 2–14 Cliff Road Wollongong from December 9 to 10, 2005. During the gathering NSW CAG will launch the MH-CoPES report produced during stage 1.

Keynote speakers, panel discussions and workshops will provide information on the various approaches being taken to develop increased levels of full and meaningful consumer, carer and family participation at all levels with evidence of improvements in quality in NSW.

The forum will also provide an opportunity to revisit the themes from NSW CAG's report *"From Consumer to Citizen"* (1996). A copy of the report is available on our website: www.nswcag.org.au.

This consumer and carer-led gathering will allow time for discussion of the current situation for people involved in mental health consumer and carer participation across NSW.

ABOUT NSW CAG

What is NSW CAG?

NSW CAG is a non-government organisation that provides an ongoing mechanism for consumer and carer input into mental health policy, service development, implementation and evaluation. NSW CAG incorporated on July 29, 1994 under the Associations Incorporation Act (NSW) 1984.

How is NSW CAG governed?

NSW CAG is governed by nine trustees who have used public or private health services, people with personal experience of mental health problems or people who are family members or carers of a person with a mental illness. Membership is achieved through an application process and reflects the makeup of the consumer and carer community.

NSW CAG members work to:

- provide direct linkages with state and national mental health policy makers and advisory bodies;
- respond to policy documents and strategies that affect consumers and carers;
- provide consumer and carer representatives/speakers to participate in relevant consultations, working parties and committees;
- facilitate communication with consumer and carer groups throughout NSW;
- promote recognition of psychiatric disability in the wider disability context;
- work in partnership with government and non government agencies to promote consumer participation, representation and advocacy;
- hold seminars, forums and conferences.

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GUIDELINES FOR ABSTRACTS

We invite submissions for papers and posters that describe innovations, research and evaluation programs, outcomes, effective practice, creative services as well as personal stories about mental illness and mental health.

The papers will be grouped with two or three other papers by topic such as: dual diagnosis, youth issues, stigma in the workplace, collaborative care planning, partnerships, recovery, consumer and carer work within the system, stigma and the media, consumer and carer groups, indigenous and CALD issues.

Abstracts

- should be no longer than 200 words
- will be used both for selection purposes and if selected will go into the Book of Abstracts
- should include a statement of the aims of the presentation
- must contain sufficient information to allow a delegate to learn what may be gained by attending the presentation
- should include a concluding sentence to provide a strong summary for the abstract
- should include two references relevant to the topic of the abstract (additional to the 200 words).

Learning objectives

- every abstract must be accompanied by two learning objectives. These should be listed on the same page as the abstract and are additional to the 200 word abstract
- learning objective (1) answers the question: "What will people in the audience gain or learn from attending this presentation?" (Don't say what you are going to teach, but what they are going to learn)
- learning objective (2) answers the question: "How is this topic/issue relevant to mental health services and mental health issues?"
- failure to include these two learning objectives may result in the abstract not being accepted for presentation.

Types of presentations

Please note that time limits for speakers will be strictly enforced so that there is adequate time for discussion of papers or posters.

PAPERS will be 20 minutes (plus 10 minute discussion). The papers will be presented in a 90-minute session conducted by a chairperson who is selected by the program committee.

The people whose abstracts for posters are accepted will be sent information outlining the requirements for displaying them.

Maximum number of presenters: two per paper or poster.

At the time of the conference participants will be asked to provide NSW CAG with a copy of their presentation (a printed copy along with an MS Word file on a PC-formatted disk).

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OFFICIAL ABSTRACT FORM FOR ORAL OR POSTER PRESENTATION

Author(s) details [please tick presenting author(s) maximum of two]

Given Name	Family Name	Address	Phone	Presenting

Oral or poster title:

Abstract no more than 200 words (on separate sheet)

Tick one box below that would best describe your presentation:



Oral presentation



Poster presentation

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personal stories about recovery from mental illness/mental health	Program service evaluation with data	Program service evaluation without data (eg creative services)	Research with data	Others: please describe

The topic that best describes my presentation is: (see guidelines on previous page)

Partners working to promote the conference

The Illawarra Institute for Mental Health, University of Wollongong conducts applied mental health research aiming to improve mental health service provision. This research has included consumer participation research such as the recent Consumer Evaluation of Mental Health Services (CEO-MHS) project that attracted a Gold Award at the 2004 TheMHS conference. Other important work at iIMH examines the roles of carers in assisting those with mental health issues. iIMH is also an important partner in the Australian Integrated Mental Health Initiative (AIMhi), examining the outcomes of a recovery related training program. iIMH involves consumer researchers in several of its key projects.

The closing date for ABSTRACTS is Friday August 28th 2005

Abstracts should be sent to:

**The Conference Secretariat,
NSW CAG,**

PO Box 1108

Rozelle NSW 2039

E-mail:

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www.nswcag.org.au